StoryCast: Research and Documentation

Listen. Watch. Connect.

This document describes how StoryCast was planned and designed, the choices considered during development, and how those choices shaped the website.

1. Project Overview

StoryCast is a small website that brings video and audio stories together in one place. Visitors can discover stories, watch or listen to them, read what was said, and learn about the purpose of the project.

The website was organised around three main pages. The Home page introduces StoryCast and highlights selected stories. The Story Detail page presents one story at a time, with its media, a short introduction, a transcript, and links to other stories. The About / Access page explains the purpose of the project and how the site supports visitors who use different ways to access content.

2. Research and Design Considerations

Storytelling and audio-content websites such as StoryCorps and LibriVox were reviewed for reference during planning. Web accessibility guidance was also considered to understand how visitors with different needs might use the site. These references informed the decision to keep the pages simple and provide text alongside audio and video.

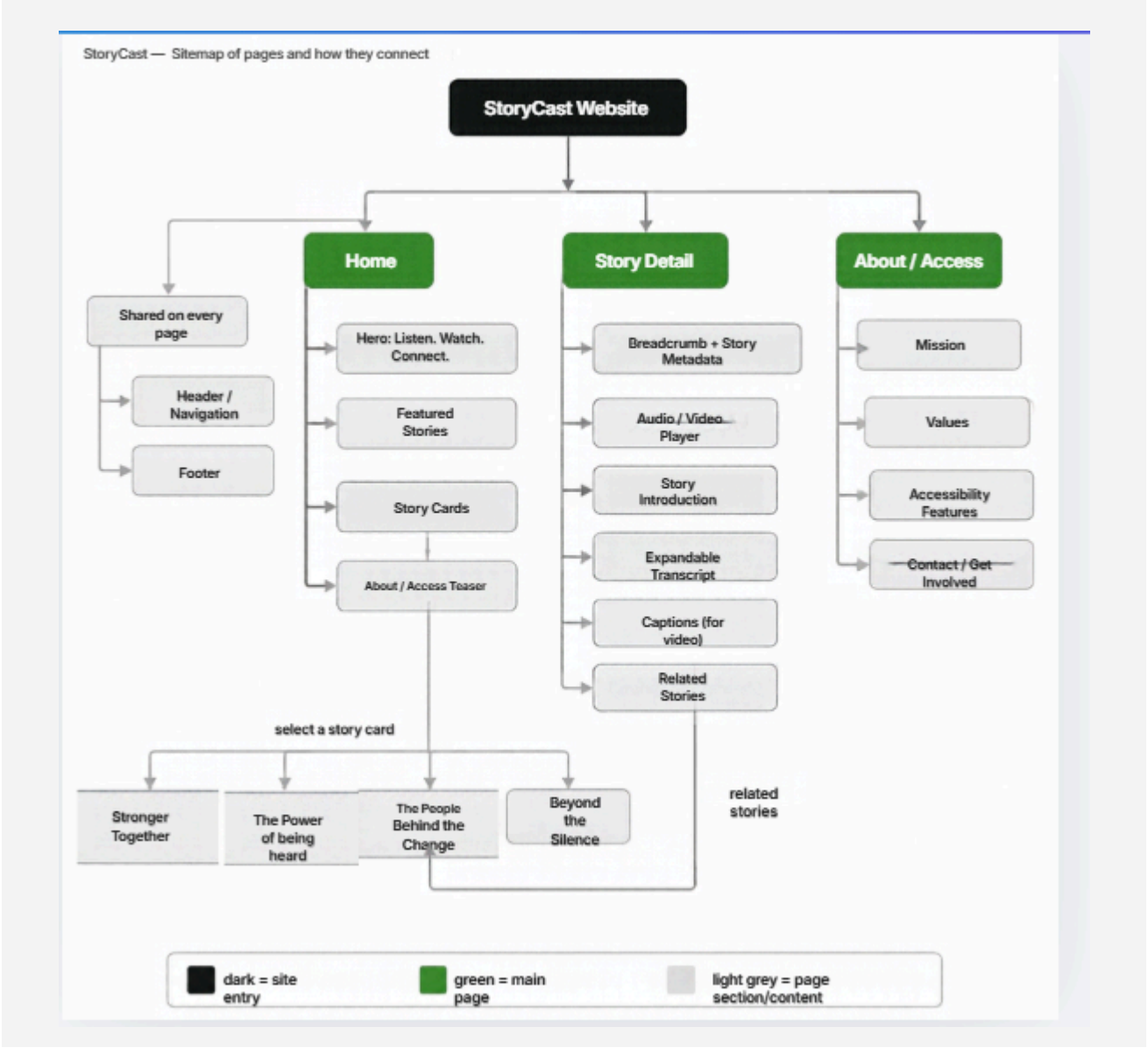
One important choice was to make stories available in more than one way. A visitor may prefer watching a video, listening to audio, or reading a transcript. Captions also help visitors who are deaf or hard of hearing follow video content. Clear headings, readable text, keyboard navigation, and visible focus indicators help visitors move through the site more easily.

The intended audience includes people who enjoy short personal stories, as well as visitors who may need captions, transcripts, screen readers, keyboard controls, or larger text to use the website comfortably.

3. Information Architecture

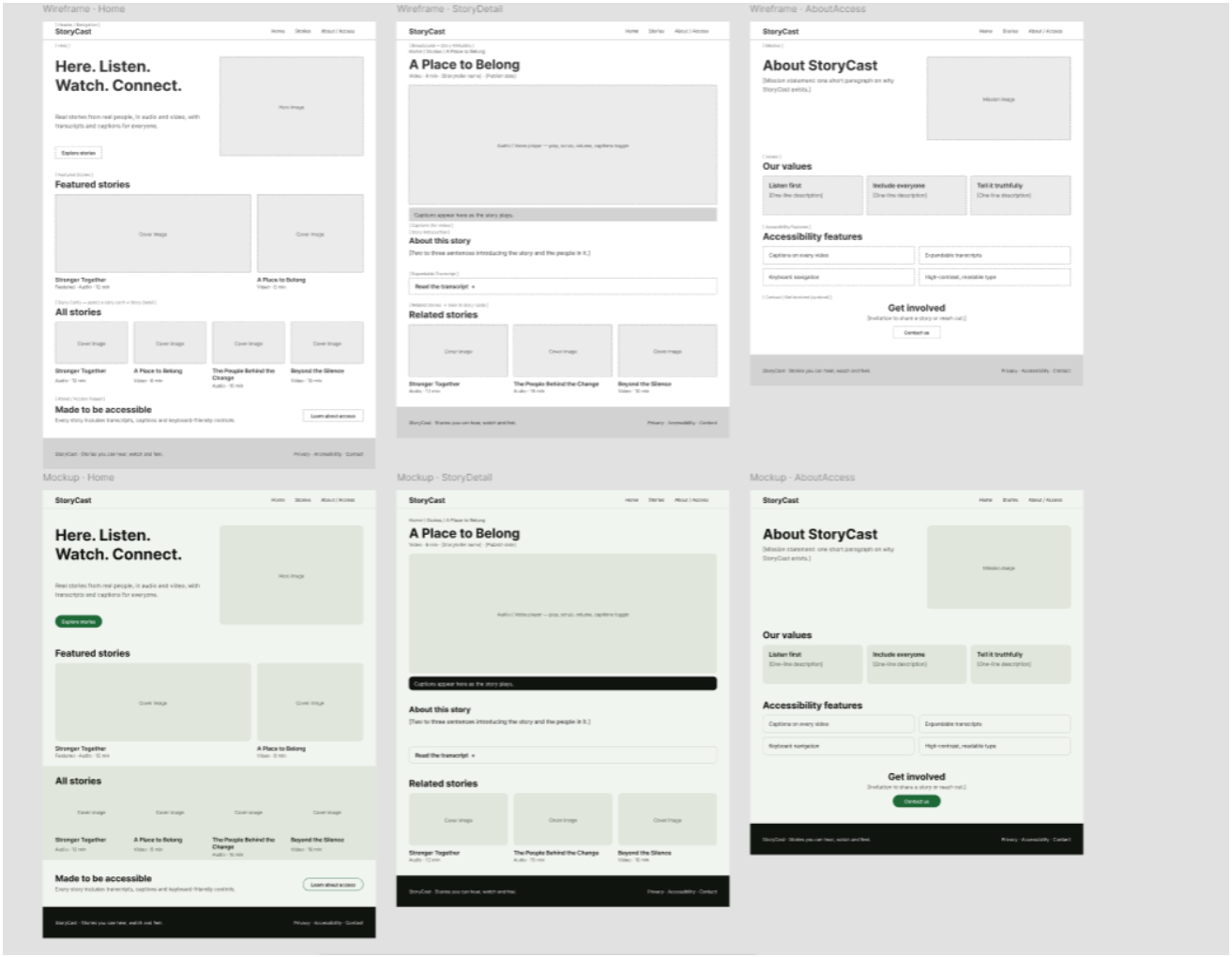
After the main pages were defined, their connections were mapped. The sitemap shows the Home page, the reusable Story Detail page, and the About / Access page, along with the shared header and footer used throughout the site.

From Home, visitors can open a story by selecting a featured story card or visit About / Access to learn more about StoryCast. On a Story Detail page, they can read the transcript and follow links to related stories. This keeps the main routes clear without adding separate search, category, or account pages to the current design.



4. Wireframes and High-Fidelity Mockups

Once the page structure was established, the layout of each page was planned and the visual direction was developed. The wireframes show where the main content is placed, while the high-fidelity mockups show the pages with colours, typography, spacing, and other visual details. Both are included in the same Figma design document.



Figma link:
https://www.figma.com/design/LCbn5r3csiLfPgBkd6644h/StoryCast-%E2%80%94-Wireframes---Mockups?node-id=0-1&t=wfvQRgqaNfU0lXMP-1

Home

The Home page begins with the message “Listen. Watch. Connect.” and a short introduction to the site. Featured story cards give visitors a direct way to explore content, while a section near the bottom introduces the About / Access page.

Story Detail

The Story Detail page uses the same layout for each story. It includes the story title and details, an audio or video player, an introduction, an expandable transcript, and links to related stories. Reusing this layout keeps the experience familiar as visitors move between stories.

About / Access

The About / Access page explains the purpose of StoryCast and the values behind it. It also describes features such as transcripts, video captions, keyboard access, and readable layouts, helping visitors understand how the site is designed to support them.

5. Building the Website

The website is being built with HTML for page content, Sass for styling, and . A front-end framework was not used, keeping the project focused on core web technologies.

The styles are organised into smaller Sass files for colours, typography, spacing, layout, components, responsive rules, and accessibility. This structure makes shared styles easier to update and reduces repeated code across pages. Flexbox is used for the header and navigation, while CSS Grid is used to arrange story cards and page sections. Responsive styles adjust the layout for smaller screens.

The project also requires a container query. This lets a component respond to the space available around it, rather than only to the full browser window.

6. Accessibility and Media

Accessibility was considered as part of the page structure and visual design. A skip link, clear navigation, visible keyboard focus, and readable text were included. Transcripts provide a text version of spoken content, and captions support video viewing when available. Images that convey information should have useful alternative text, while decorative images can use empty alternative text.

Media use was also considered. Videos and audio are intended to be controlled by visitors rather than starting automatically. Before a story is published, its source, permitted use, attribution, and transcript rights are checked.